“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 3

An Account of the Glories of Śrī Haridāsa Ṭhākura

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I bow down to the beautiful lotus feet of my guru, to all the gurus and to the Vaiṣṇavas. I bow down to Śrī Rūpa, together with his elder brother, Sanātana, with his companions and Raghunātha, and with Jīva; to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva, together with Advaita, with the Avadhūta, Nityānanda, and with all His associates; and to the feet of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, together with Lalitā and Śrī Viśākhā and their companions.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 In Puruṣottama there lived an Oriyā brāhmaṇa boy, fatherless, very handsome and gentle in his manner.

4 Every day he came to the Lord and offered Him obeisance. He would talk with the Lord, for the Lord was his very ‘life’.

5 The boy loved the Lord, and the Lord was kind to him; but Dāmodara could not tolerate the boy’s affection.

6 Again and again he forbade the brāhmaṇa boy to come, but the boy could not stay away without seeing the Lord.

7 He came every day, and the Lord treated him with great affection. A child goes where he is loved — such is the way of children.

8 Seeing this, Dāmodara was troubled at heart, yet he could say nothing more, for the boy would not heed his prohibition.

9 One day the boy came to the Lord again, and the Lord affectionately asked him how he was.

10 After a while, when the boy got up and left, Dāmodara could bear it no longer and began to speak.

11 He said to the Lord, "When it comes to instructing others, You are a paṇḍita, and everyone hails You, 'Gosāñi! Gosāñi!' Now we shall see what kind of Gosāñi You are.[3]

12 Now all the people will sing the Gosāñi's qualities, and the Gosāñi's fame will spread all over Puruṣottama!"

13 Hearing this, the Lord said, "What are you saying, Dāmodara?" Dāmodara said, "You are the independent Lord.

14 You behave as You please — who can say anything to You? But can You stop the mouths of a talkative world?

15 You are a paṇḍita — why do You not consider this? Why do You show such affection to the son of a widowed brāhmaṇī?

16 Although that brāhmaṇī is austere and chaste, she has one fault: she is young and beautiful.

17 And You too are very young and very handsome. You are giving people occasion for gossip.”

18 Having said this, Dāmodara fell silent. The Lord, pleased at heart, smiled and reflected:

19 “This is what I call a wave of pure love. I have no intimate associate like Dāmodara.”

20 Reflecting thus, the Lord went to attend to His midday duties. The next day He called Dāmodara to Him in private.

21 The Lord said, “Dāmodara, go to Nadīyā and stay there near My mother.

22 She has no protector other than you, for you have cautioned even Me.

23 Among My associates there is no one as impartial (*nirapekṣa*) as you, and without impartiality dharma cannot be protected.

24 What I cannot do, you can. You have chastised even Me — what then of anyone else?[4]

25 Go and stay in My mother’s house, at her feet. Before you no one will dare to behave as he pleases.

26 From time to time you may come to see Me, but then go back there quickly.

27 Convey to My mother My obeisances millions of times, and gladden her by telling her how happy I am.

28 Tell her: ‘The Lord has sent me here so that I may always bring you news of Him.’

29 Saying this, bring satisfaction to My mother's heart. And remind her of a confidential matter:

30 'Again and again I come to your house and eat all the sweets and vegetable dishes.

31 I do eat them, and you know it; but in the external state of separation you take it to be only a vision (*sphūrti*).[5]

32 At this last Māgha-saṅkrānti you cooked many vegetable dishes, condensed milk, cakes and sweet rice.

33 When you had offered the food to Kṛṣṇa and were meditating, I appeared to you, and your eyes filled with tears.

34 I went in haste and ate everything, and when you saw Me eating, joy arose in you.

35 A moment later, wiping your tears, you saw that the plate was empty and thought, "I have had a dream that Nimāi ate the rice."

36 In that state of external separation you were confused again and thought, "I have not offered the food."

37 You looked in the cooking pots and saw that they were all full of food. So, having cleansed the place, you offered the food again.

38 In this way I eat again and again; your pure love draws Me.

39 It is by your order that I stay in Nīlācala, yet by the power of your love you bring Me to your side.'

40 Remind her in this way again and again, and worship her feet in My name."

41 Saying this, the Lord had Jagannātha's prasāda brought and gave it to him in separate portions for His mother and for the Vaiṣṇavas.

42 Then Dāmodara set out and came to Nadīyā. He met the Lord's mother and remained at her feet.

43 He gave the mahā-prasāda to the Ācārya (Advaita) and the other Vaiṣṇavas. Just as the Lord had ordered, so the Paṇḍita did.

44 Before Dāmodara no one dared to act independently; out of fear of him everyone behaved with restraint.

45 Whenever he saw any of the Lord's associates commit even a slight breach of propriety, he chastised him with words and so established proper conduct.

46 Thus I have told of Dāmodara's chastisement with words; by hearing of it, ignorance and unbelief (*pāṣaṇḍa*) flee.[6]

47 Caitanya's pastimes are deeper than millions of oceans. No one can understand what He does or why.

48 Therefore I know nothing of their hidden meaning; I struggle even to give them an outward meaning.

49 One day the Lord met Haridāsa, and as they conversed He asked him:[7]

50 "Haridāsa, in the age of Kali the yavanas are countless. They are very wicked and do violence to cows and brāhmaṇas.

51 How will all of them be delivered? I see no means for it, and this grief of Mine is boundless."

52 Haridāsa said, "Lord, do not worry. Do not grieve at the sight of the yavanas' worldly bondage (*saṁsāra*).

53 All the yavanas will attain liberation easily, for they say 'hā rāma, hā rāma', and so they utter the semblance of the name (*nāmābhāsa*).[8]

54 In great love a devotee cries, 'Hā Rāma! Hā Rāma!' See the good fortune of the yavanas: they utter that very name!

55 When the name is uttered to point (*saṅketa*) to something else, that is *nāmābhāsa*; yet even then the potency of the name is not destroyed.

56 "A *mleccha* struck by a boar's tusk who cries 'hā rāma' again and again attains liberation by that alone. What then of one who chants the name with faith?" (Nṛsiṁha Purāṇa)[9]

57 Ajāmila called his son by saying 'Nārāyaṇa', and the messengers of Viṣṇu came and released him from his bonds.

58 In 'hā rāma' the two syllables of 'Rāma' are not separated, and they are adorned with the word 'hā', which expresses love.

59 Such is the nature of the syllables of the name: even when they are broken apart, they do not give up their power.[10]

60 "O brāhmaṇa, if even one name of the Lord is on a person's tongue, or has come into his memory, or has reached his ears, it will surely deliver him — whether its sounds are correct or incorrect, whether it is uttered whole, broken or only in part. This is the truth. But if the name is set amid con-

cerns for the body, wealth and followers, or amid greed and godlessness, it will not quickly bear its fruit here." (Padma Purāṇa; Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 11.289)[11]

61 Through *nāmābhāsa* all sins are destroyed; through *nāmābhāsa* worldly existence comes to an end.

62 "O treasure of virtues, with your mind delighting in faith, quickly and without deceit worship Him, the purifier of all purifiers, the crown of those whose glory is sung in the finest verses. Ah! When even the faint light of the sun of His name rises in the cave of the heart, it dispels the massed darkness of great sins." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.103)[12]

63 "Even Ajāmila reached the Lord's abode by uttering the name of Hari as he was dying, though he addressed it to his son. What then of one who utters the name with faith?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.2.49)[13]

64 In all the scriptures I see that liberation comes through *nāmābhāsa*, and in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* Ajāmila is the witness to it."

65 Hearing this, the Lord felt His happiness grow within. Then, as if to test him, He asked again:

66 "On the earth there are many living beings, nonmoving and moving. How will all of them be released?"

67 Haridāsa said, "Lord, that is by Your mercy: You have already delivered the nonmoving and moving beings.

68 You have performed this loud saṅkīrtana, and the nonmoving and moving beings have all heard it.

69 By hearing it, the moving beings are freed from worldly existence; and when that sound strikes the nonmoving beings, an echo arises.

70 It is not an ‘echo’: they are performing ‘kīrtana’. This is a tale of Your mercy beyond all telling.

71 Throughout the world there is loud saṅkīrtana, and hearing it, the nonmoving and moving beings dance, absorbed in prema.

72 Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya has told me how You did this in Jhārikhaṇḍa on Your way to Vṛndāvana.

73 When Vāsudeva petitioned You on behalf of the jīvas, You agreed to release them.

74 You have descended to deliver the world, and for that You first accepted the mood of a devotee.

75 So You spread loud saṅkīrtana and cut off the worldly existence of all jīvas, nonmoving and moving.”

76 The Lord said, “If all the jīvas attain liberation, then this universe will be empty of jīvas!”

77–78 Haridāsa said, “As long as You remain in the mortal world, You will liberate all the nonmoving and moving beings of every species and send them to Vaikuṇṭha. Then You will awaken the subtle jīvas (*sūkṣma-jīva*) to karma once again.[14]

79 Those jīvas will become the nonmoving and moving beings here, and with them the universe will be filled as before.

80 Just as formerly Raghunātha (Rāmacandra) took all of Ayodhyā with Him to Vaikuṇṭha and filled Ayodhyā with other jīvas,[15]

81 so You too, having descended, have set up Your market here. No one can understand Your hidden play.

82 Formerly, when Kṛṣṇa descended in Vraja, He cut off the worldly existence of all the jīvas in the universe.

83 "There should be no wonder at such deeds of Kṛṣṇa, the unborn Bhagavān, the Lord of the lords of yoga; for by Him this whole world, moving and unmoving, is set free." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.16)[16]

84 "When this Bhagavān is seen, glorified or remembered even with persistent enmity, He bestows a fruit hard to attain for all the gods, demons and others. What then of those who have perfect devotion?" (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 4.15.10)[17]

85 Likewise, You have descended in Navadvīpa and delivered the jīvas of the whole universe.

86 If someone says, 'The glory of Caitanya is within my grasp,' let him know it; but my own conviction is this:

87 Your pastimes are an ocean of great nectar, and not even a single drop of it is within the reach of my mind."

88 Hearing this, the Lord was amazed at heart: "How has Haridāsa come to know My hidden pastimes?"

89 In the satisfaction of His heart He embraced him, but He avoided revealing this outwardly.

90 It is the Lord's nature to wish to conceal His majesty, but He cannot hide it from His devotees: to them it becomes known.

91 "Your sovereign nature transcends the three kinds of limits and admits of no equal or superior. Though You hide it by the power of Your māyā, some who are devoted to You alone see it constantly." (Stotra-ratna, 18)[18]

92 Then Mahāprabhu went to His own devotees and spoke of Haridāsa's qualities as if He had a hundred mouths.

93 The Lord's delight grows when He speaks of a devotee's qualities — and Śrī Haridāsa, moreover, is the best of all devotees.

94 Haridāsa's qualities are countless and boundless. One may describe some portion of them, but no one reaches their end.

95 In the *Caitanya-maṅgala* (the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*) Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa has revealed some of Haridāsa's qualities.[19]

96 It is impossible to tell all of Haridāsa's character; one tells a little of it to purify oneself.

97 O devotees, hear of some of Haridāsa's qualities that Vṛndāvana dāsa did not describe.

98 When Haridāsa left his home, he lived for some time in the forest of Benāpola.

99 He built a hut in the solitary forest, served Tulasī, and night and day chanted three hundred thousand names.

100 He lived on alms taken in brāhmaṇas' houses, and by his spiritual power he won the reverence of all the people.

101 The ruler of that district was named Rāmacandra Khān. He hated the Vaiṣṇavas and was the chief of the unbelievers.

102 He could not bear that the people revered Haridāsa, and he contrived various means to dishonour him.

103 Unable to find any fault in Haridāsa by any means, he brought in prostitutes and schemed to create one.

104 He said to the prostitutes, “There is a renunciant named Haridāsa. Go, all of you, and destroy his vow of renunciation.”

105 Among the prostitutes was a beautiful young woman. She said, “In three days I shall captivate his mind.”

106 Khān said, “Let my constable go with you, so that he may seize him together with you and bring him here.”

107 The prostitute said, “Let him first be with me once. The second time I shall take your constable to seize him.”

108 At night the prostitute dressed herself finely and went to Haridāsa’s dwelling, full of delight.

109 She bowed to Tulasī, went to Haridāsa’s door, bowed to the Gosāñi and stood there.

110 Baring her body to his view, she sat down at the door and began to speak in a very sweet voice:

111 “Ṭhākura, you are most handsome and in the first bloom of youth. What woman could keep her composure on seeing you?

112 My heart longs for union with you. If I do not have you, I cannot go on living."

113–114 Haridāsa said, "I shall accept you. But until I have finished chanting my fixed number of names, sit here and listen to the saṅkīrtana of the name. When my chanting is finished, I shall do as you wish."

115 Hearing this, the prostitute sat and waited. Haridāsa went on chanting until morning came.

116 Seeing that it was morning, the prostitute got up and left, and she told Rāmacandra Khān the news:

117 "He has given his word that he will be with me today. I shall certainly be united with him."

118 The next day, when night fell, the prostitute came, and Haridāsa reassured her warmly:

119 "Yesterday you were disappointed; please do not hold it against me. I shall certainly accept you.

120 Until then, sit here and listen to the saṅkīrtana of the name. When the name is complete, your heart too will be fulfilled."

121 Then the prostitute bowed to Tulasī, sat down at the door and listened to the name, saying, 'Hari! Hari!'

122 As the night was ending, the prostitute grew restless. Seeing her manner, Haridāsa said to her:

123 "I have taken a vow to perform a sacrifice of chanting ten million names in one month, and it is now nearing its end.[20]

124 I thought it would be finished today. I chanted the name the whole night, yet it was not completed.

125 Tomorrow it will be finished and my vow will be over; then I shall freely be with you."

126 The prostitute went and told Khān the news. The next day she came to the Ṭhākura in the evening.

127 Bowing to Tulasī and to the Ṭhākura, she sat at the door and listened to the name, saying, 'Hari! Hari!'

128 "Today the name will be completed," said Haridāsa. "Then I shall fulfil your desire."

129 As he chanted, the night came to an end; and through the Ṭhākura's company the prostitute's heart was transformed.

130 She fell flat at the Ṭhākura's feet and confessed Rāmacandra Khān's plot.

131 "Being a prostitute, I have committed boundless sins. Be merciful and deliver this fallen soul."

132 The Ṭhākura said, "I know all about Khān's plot. He is an ignorant fool, and I feel no grief on his account.

133 I would have left this place that very day; I stayed three days for your sake."

134 The prostitute said, "Be merciful and instruct me: what must I do to be freed from the suffering of material existence?"

135 The Ṭhākura said, “Give away the goods of your house to brāhmaṇas, and then come and live in this hut.

136 Chant the name constantly and serve Tulasī. Then you will very soon attain the feet of Kṛṣṇa.”

137 Saying this, he instructed her in chanting the name. Then the Ṭhākura rose and departed, calling, “Hari! Hari!”

138 Then the prostitute accepted her guru’s order and gave to the brāhmaṇas whatever wealth she had in her house.

139 She shaved her head and stayed in that hut with a single cloth, chanting three hundred thousand names day and night.

140 She served Tulasī and ate sparingly or fasted. Her senses were subdued, and love (prema) appeared in her.

141 She became a renowned and most exalted Vaiṣṇavī, and great Vaiṣṇavas would go to see her.

142 Seeing the conduct of the former prostitute, people were amazed, and bowing down, they spoke of Haridāsa’s glory.

143 Rāmacandra Khān sowed the seed of an offence; that seed grew into a tree and later bore its fruit.

144 The fruit of an offence against a great soul makes a wonderful account. Since the occasion has come, I shall tell it; listen, O devotees.

145 Rāmacandra Khān was by nature no Vaiṣṇava, and by his offence against Haridāsa he became like a demon.

146 He reviled the religion of the Vaiṣṇavas and insulted them, and for the offences of many days he reaped the consequence.

147 When Nityānanda Gosāñi came to Gauḍa, He began to travel about, preaching love of God.

148 To preach love and to crush the unbelievers — for these two tasks the Avadhūta wandered.

149 The all-knowing Nityānanda came to his house and sat down on the *durgā-maṇḍapa*, the pavilion for the worship of Durgā.[21]

150 The many people with Him filled the courtyard, and from inside the house Rāmacandra sent a servant.

151 The servant said, “Gosāñi, the Khān has sent me. I shall give You lodging in a householder’s house.

152 A cowherd’s cowshed is very spacious, but this place is narrow, and Your people are countless.”[22]

153 Gosāñi had been sitting within. Hearing this, He came out in anger and, laughing loudly, began to speak:

154 “He speaks the truth: this house is not fit for Me. It is fit for the *mlecchas*, who slaughter cows.”[23]

155 Saying this, Gosāñi rose in anger and left. To punish him, He did not stay in that village.[24]

156 Meanwhile Rāmacandra Khān ordered a servant to dig up the earth where Gosāñi had sat.

157 He had the whole temple and courtyard smeared with cow-dung water, yet Rāmacandra's mind was still not satisfied.

158 Rāmacandra lived like a robber and did not pay the king his taxes. Angered, the *mleccha* minister came to his house.

159 Coming there, he lodged in that very *durgā-maṇḍapa*; he slaughtered what must never be killed and cooked its meat in the house.

160 He bound Rāmacandra together with his wife and sons, and staying three days, he plundered his house and village.

161 For three days he cooked unclean food in that house, and on the next day he left, taking them all with him.

162 He took everything from the Khān — his caste, his wealth and his people — and the village lay desolate for many days.

163 Wherever a great soul is dishonoured, in a land or a village, the whole land is laid waste for the fault of a single person.[25]

164 Walking on, Haridāsa Ṭhākura came to Cāḍapura and stayed in the house of Balarāma Ācārya.

165 Hiraṇya and Govardhana kept the revenue accounts of the district as its Majumadāras, and their priest was named Balarāma.[26]

166 He had received Haridāsa's mercy, and so, with devotion and respect, he looked after the Ṭhākura with care in that village.

167 Haridāsa chanted in a solitary hut of leaves and took his alms (*bhikṣā*) at Balarāma Ācārya's house.

168 Raghunātha dāsa, then a boy at his studies, would go to see Haridāsa Ṭhākura.

169 Haridāsa bestowed his mercy upon him, and that mercy became the cause of his attaining Caitanya.

170 Listen, O devotees, to the wonderful account of the discussion about Haridāsa that took place there.

171 One day, after humbly entreating him, Balarāma brought the Ṭhākura to the assembly of the Majumadāras.

172 Seeing the Ṭhākura, the two brothers rose to greet him; they fell at his feet and respectfully offered him a seat.

173 In the assembly were many scholars, brāhmaṇas and gentlemen, and the two brothers, Hiraṇya and Govardhana, were themselves great scholars.

174 Everyone praised Haridāsa's virtues as if with five mouths, and hearing this, the two brothers were very happy.

175 The Ṭhākura chanted three hundred thousand names, and so the scholars raised the subject of the glory of the name.

176 One said, "From the name comes the destruction of sins." Another said, "From the name the soul attains liberation."

177 Haridāsa said, "These two are not the fruit of the name. The fruit of the name is that love for Kṛṣṇa's feet arises.[27]

178 "One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the

world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)[28]

179 Liberation and the destruction of sin are only incidental fruits of the name. The example is the light of the sun.[29]

180 "As the sun, merely by rising, dispels an ocean of darkness, so the name of Hari, rising even once, destroys all the sins of all people. All glory to that name of Hari, the blessing of the world!" (Nāma-kaumudī of Śrī Lakṣmīdhara Svāmī; Padyāvalī, 16)[30]

181 O scholars, explain the meaning of this verse." They all said, "You explain its meaning."

182–183 Haridāsa said, "It is like the rising of the sun: even before it has risen, darkness begins to vanish, and the fear of thieves, ghosts, Rākṣasas and the like comes to an end. When it has risen, religious duties, works and all else come to light.

184 In the same way, as the name begins to rise, sins and the like are destroyed; when it has risen, love for Kṛṣṇa's feet dawns.[31]

185 Liberation is a trifling fruit that comes from the mere semblance of the name (*nāmābhāsa*). Kṛṣṇa wishes to give that liberation, but His devotee does not accept it."[32]

186 "Even Ajāmila reached the Lord's abode by uttering the name of Hari as he was dying, though he addressed it to his son. What then of one who utters the name with faith?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.2.49)[33]

187 "My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me,

a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)[34]

188 There was a man named Gopāla Cakravartī, the chief tax collector (*ārindā*) of the Majumadāras' house.

189 Living in Gauḍa, he served the Pātsāhā as a tax collector and delivered twelve lakhs (1,200,000) of coins into his treasury.[35]

190 He was very handsome, learned and in the first bloom of youth. Hearing that liberation comes from the semblance of the name, he could not tolerate it.

191 Becoming angry, he spoke wrathful words: "Hear the conclusion of this sentimentalist, O scholars!

192 The liberation that is not attained by knowledge of Brahman even in ten million births — that liberation, he says, comes from the mere semblance of the name!"

193 Haridāsa said, "Why do you doubt? The scriptures say that liberation comes from the mere semblance of the name.

194 Beside the happiness of devotion, liberation is utterly trifling; therefore the devotees do not accept it.

195 "O Guru of the world, now that I am immersed in the pure ocean of joy that comes from seeing You face to face, all other joys — even the bliss of Brahman — seem to me like the water in a calf's hoofprint." (Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya, 14.36)[36]

196 The brāhmaṇa said, “If liberation does not come from the semblance of the name, then pledge that you will cut off your nose!”[37]

197 Haridāsa said, “If liberation does not come from the semblance of the name, then I shall cut off my own nose — that is certain.”

198 Hearing this, the members of the assembly rose with an outcry, and the Majumadāras rebuked that brāhmaṇa.

199 The priest Balāi (Balarāma) reproached him: “You are a fool who argues about pots and cloth (*ghaṭa-paṭiyā*) — what do you know of devotion?[38]

200 You have insulted Haridāsa Ṭhākura! You will be utterly ruined; no good will come to you.”

201 Hearing this, Haridāsa rose and departed, and the Majumadāras dismissed that brāhmaṇa.

202 Together with the whole assembly they fell at Haridāsa’s feet, and Haridāsa, smiling, spoke sweet words:

203 “None of you is at fault, nor is this ignorant brāhmaṇa to blame: his mind is devoted to logic.

204 The greatness of the name lies beyond the reach of logic. How could he know these truths?

205 Go home. May Kṛṣṇa bless you all, and may no one suffer on my account.”[39]

206 Then Hiraṇya dāsa returned to his own house and forbade that brāhmaṇa to enter his door.

207 Within three days that brāhmaṇa contracted leprosy, and his very prominent nose rotted and fell off.

208 His fingers and toes, once like campaka buds, all shrivelled and rotted away with leprosy.

209 Seeing this, everyone was amazed; they praised Haridāsa and bowed down to him.

210 Although Haridāsa did not take the brāhmaṇa's offence to heart, the Lord nevertheless made him taste its fruit.

211 It is the nature of a devotee to forgive the faults of the ignorant; it is Kṛṣṇa's nature that He cannot bear blasphemy of His devotee.

212 Hearing of the brāhmaṇa's suffering, Haridāsa was saddened at heart. Taking leave of the priest Balāi, he came to Śāntipura.

213 Meeting the Ācārya, he fell before Him in obeisance, and Advaita embraced him and honoured him.

214 On the bank of the Gaṅgā He made a secluded cave-dwelling for him, and He explained to him the devotional meaning of the *Bhāgavata* and the *Gītā*.

215 Haridāsa took his alms daily at the Ācārya's house, and together the two of them relished talks about Kṛṣṇa.

216 Haridāsa said, "Gosāñi, I have something to submit to You. Why do You give me food every day?

217 Here are great brāhmaṇas, a society of the high-born, and yet You honour me and feel no shame!

218 Your conduct is extraordinary; I am afraid even to speak of it. Please be merciful and act so that Your own standing is protected."[40]

219 The Ācārya said, "Do not be afraid. I shall act only as the scriptures direct.

220 When you eat, it is as good as feeding ten million brāhmaṇas." Saying this, He fed him the *śrāddha-pātra*, the food of the day of *śrāddha*.[41]

221 He was always thinking of how to deliver the world: "How will this world, devoid of Vaiṣṇavas, be delivered?"

222 Advaita vowed to bring Kṛṣṇa down to this world, and He began to worship Him with water and tulasī.

223 In his cave Haridāsa chanted the name, with this one thought in his mind: "Kṛṣṇa will descend."

224 By the devotion of these two Caitanya descended, and by preaching the name and love He delivered the world.

225 There is another extraordinary deed of his, which amazes people when they hear it.

226 Do not argue: his ways are beyond argument. Hear it with faith and conviction.

227 One day Haridāsa was sitting in his cave, chanting the name aloud.

228 It was a moonlit night; the ten directions were perfectly clear, and the waves of the Gaṅgā glittered in the moonlight.

229 At the door was Tulasī, on a plastered platform. The cave was so beautiful that the heart of anyone who saw it was soothed.

230 At that time a woman came into the courtyard, and the lustre of her body turned the whole place golden.

231 The fragrance of her body perfumed the ten directions, and the tinkling of her ornaments thrilled the ears.

232 Coming in, she bowed down to Tulasī, circumambulated her and went to the door of the cave.

233 With joined palms she honoured Haridāsa's feet, and sitting at the door, she spoke some sweet words:

234 "You are the friend of the whole world, endowed with beauty and virtue. I have come here for your company.

235 Be kind and accept me. To show mercy to the lowly — that is the nature of a saint."

236 Saying this, she displayed various alluring moods, the sight of which would make even a sage lose his composure.

237 But Haridāsa, unmoved and deep of heart, began to speak to her kindly:

238 "Chanting the name by a fixed count is what I consider the great sacrifice (*mahā-yajña*), and every day I am consecrated to it.

239 Until the chanting is complete, I do nothing else; when the chanting is complete, my vow is at rest.[42]

240 Sit at the door and listen to the chanting of the name. When the name is completed, I shall do what pleases you."

241 Saying this, he went on chanting the name, and the woman sat and listened to the holy name.

242 While he chanted, dawn came, and seeing that it was morning, the woman rose and left.

243 In this way she came for three days, displaying moods that could captivate even Brahmā's mind.

244 Haridāsa's mind was always absorbed in the name of Kṛṣṇa, so her display of feminine charms was like crying in the wilderness.[43]

245 When the third night was coming to an end, the woman said to the Ṭhākura:

246 "For three days you have deceived me with promises. Night and day, your chanting of the name never ends."

247 Haridāsa Ṭhākura said, "What can I do? I have made a vow — how can I give it up?"

248 Then, bowing down to him, the woman said, "I am Māyā. I came to test you.

249 I have bewitched all living beings, beginning with Brahmā; you alone I could not bewitch.

250–251 You are a great devotee (*mahā-bhāgavata*). By seeing you and hearing you chant Kṛṣṇa's name, my heart has become pure and longs to take Kṛṣṇa's name. Be merciful to me: instruct me in Kṛṣṇa's name.

252 With Caitanya's descent a flood of the nectar of love is flowing. All living beings float in that love, and the earth has become blessed.

253 Wretched is the soul who does not float in this flood: for him there is no deliverance even in millions of *kalpas*.[44]

254 Long ago I received the name of Rāma from Śiva; now, by your company, I long to take the name of Kṛṣṇa.

255 The name of Rāma is the *tāraka-brahma*, the Brahman that delivers, the cause of liberation; the name of Kṛṣṇa, the *pāraka*, carries one across and gives love.

256 Give me Kṛṣṇa's name and make me blessed, so that this flood of love may sweep me away too."

257 Saying this, she honoured Haridāsa's feet. Haridāsa said, "Chant the name of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana*)."[45]

258 Having received his instruction, Māyā departed, pleased. Yet some people do not believe such accounts.

259 To make them believe, I shall tell the reason for it; hearing it, everyone will have faith.

260 At the descent of Caitanya, Brahmā, Śiva, Sanaka and the others, eager for love of Kṛṣṇa, took birth on earth.

261 Taking Kṛṣṇa's name, they dance and float in the flood of love. Nārada, Prahlāda and others came in human form.

262 Lakṣmī and others, eager for love of Kṛṣṇa, took birth as human beings and relished the name and love.

263 What to speak of others? The son of the king of Vraja Himself descends and relishes love and the name.[46]

264 If Māyā, the Lord's maidservant, begs for love, what wonder is there in that? Without the mercy of a saint and the name, love is never born.[47]

265 Such is the very nature of Caitanya Gosāñi's pastimes: the three worlds dance and sing, having attained the mood of love.

266 Kṛṣṇa Himself and the others, and all beings, moving and unmoving — *kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana* makes them all mad with love of Kṛṣṇa.[48]

267 The pastimes that Svarūpa Gosāñi recorded in his notebook (*kaḍacā*), and all that I heard from the mouth of Raghunātha dāsa —

268 those pastimes I tell in brief. Though I am an insignificant soul, I write by Caitanya's mercy.

269 I have told a particle of the glory of Haridāsa Ṭhākura; hearing it soothes the devotees' ears.

270 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[49]

Notes

1. This same verse opens Antya 2; translation as there. The *Anubhāṣya* refers to Antya 2.1: the śrī guru is the guru who gave initiation into the mantra, or the guru who instructs in bhajana; the gurus are the whole line of gurus (the parama-guru and those before him), headed by Śrīmad Ānandatīrtha and Śrīman Mādhavendra Purī; the Vaiṣṇavas are the bhāgavatas of all four yugas; Śrī Rūpa is honoured with his elder brother Sanātana, with his own devotees and Raghunātha dāsa, and with Jīva, whom he blessed; the companions of Lalitā and Viśākhā are the sakhīs and mañjarīs. ↩
2. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (and Ādi 4.2, where the first line has *śrī-caitanya* in place of *gauracandra*); translation as there. ↩
3. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when it comes to instructing others, You are a paṇḍita, and everyone calls You “Gosāñi” (ācārya); now it will be seen how You remain a Gosāñi. ↩
4. *Anubhāṣya*: “what does not come from Me” is the impartiality that I do not keep. ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when your gaze turns outward to the world, it seems to you only a vision (*sphūrti*): “Nimāi came to my mind.” But in truth I come to you and eat. ↩
6. The edition’s heading: hearing the account of Dāmodara’s chastisement with words destroys deceit (*kaitava*) — the desire to please one’s own senses — and offences. ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: another manuscript has here a further verse: “Having accepted chastisement in words from Dāmodara, Gaura, the ocean of mercy, then heard from Haridāsa’s mouth of His own hidden pastime.” ↩
8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (on 56): in the word *harām* (“unclean”) the name “Rāma” is present as an indication (*saṅketa*); this is called *nāmābhāsa*. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: the *mleccha* is a yavana; *hā rāma* is a word that in the yavanas’ language means something unclean, untouchable; liberation is release from the bonds of worldly existence by the power of *nāmābhāsa*, while one who chants with faith is saved by the power of the name itself. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: a mleccha wounded by a boar cried out “Harām!” in disgust, and yet at the moment of death he attained liberation. ↩
10. *Anubhāṣya*: *vyavahita* here does not mean a break born, in one without faith, of the urge for one’s own enjoyment — such a “name” is not the pure name but a mere set of material sounds, and it only obstructs the fruit of the pure name, love for Kṛṣṇa. It means the indistinct, broken or partial utterance of the name by one inclined to service: in his faithful heart Śrī Nāma Prabhu still shows His power to destroy the anarthas and awaken prema. ↩

11. The edition's heading: *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, 11.289, the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*. *Anubhāṣya*: *vyavahita-rahitam* means either "free from gaps", that is, from the ten offences against the name, or "broken and incomplete" — broken by another word, sound or mood, or lacking a part; so Śrī Sanātana also explains in the *Dig-darśinī*: such a name still frees one from sins, offences and saṁsāra, but the chief fruit of serving the name for the body's sake comes not at once but in time. *Janatā* is the desire for kin, women or fame; *pāṣaṇḍa* is disregard for Hari, the guru and the Vaiṣṇavas. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: amid offences, which are like stones, the name does not quickly bear fruit; unless one takes up the means to end offences against the name, they will not go. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: the name of the Lord is the sun, and its semblance (*ābhāsa*) is a faint light, free from the darkness of offences; the purifier of purifiers is He who purifies even the holy places; *atitarām* — "quickly"; *nirvyājam* — "without deceit". The edition's heading: *nāmābhāsa* destroys great sins. ↩
13. The edition's heading: *nāmābhāsa* gives liberation. *Anubhāṣya*: at the moment of death Ajāmila obtained the fruit of *nāmābhāsa* — of the name uttered as an indication — and was freed from sin; returning to life, he worshipped Śrī Hari in detachment and so went to Vaikuṇṭha. Having told this, Śukadeva at the end of the chapter shows how the glory of *nāmābhāsa* differs from that of the pure name: if Ajāmila, helpless and without faith, reached Vaikuṇṭha, what to speak of one who chants the name with transcendental firm faith. ↩
14. The edition's heading: Haridāsa's answer — by the Lord's mercy, once all the living beings of the time of His manifestation have been delivered, the world is filled again with jīvas brought forth by Mahā-Viṣṇu, who lies in the Causal Ocean. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: all the jīvas with whom the Lord, descending into the universe, comes into contact are delivered; yet He awakens countless subtle jīvas again on the field of karma, and so the universes are filled once more. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: see the *Rāmāyaṇa* (Baṅgavāsī edition), Uttara-kāṇḍa, sarga 122, verses 21–22, and sarga 123. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: Śukadeva spoke this to Parīkṣit while describing the good fortune of the gopīs, who on the night of the Rāsa-pūrṇimā heard Kṛṣṇa's flute and longed to meet Him: from Kṛṣṇa all living beings without exception, moving and unmoving, are freed, so one should not wonder at His power to grant liberation. ↩

17. The reference follows the edition's heading (p. 890): *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, part 4, chapter 15, verse 10. *Anubhāṣya*: the fruit is liberation and the like; those of perfect devotion are the pure devotees, who on the path of bhakti have wholly given up other desires, karma, jñāna and the rest. ↩
18. The same verse as Ādi 3.88; translation as there. The source follows the edition's heading (p. 891): Ālavandāru's (Śrī Yāmunācārya's) *Stotra-ratna*, verse 18. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (on Ādi 3.88): everything is bound by three limits — place, time and thought — but Your hidden nature, which has no equal or superior, surpasses them; You cover it by the power of māyā, yet Your exclusive devotees always see You. *Anubhāṣya*: "by the power of māyā" — by the power of His own *yogamāyā*. ↩
19. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*; see its Ādi-khaṇḍa, chapter 14. ↩
20. The edition's heading: Ṭhākura Haridāsa tells of his initiation into the mahā-mantra; a brāhmaṇa by initiation. *Anubhāṣya*: a koṭi (ten million) names are completed in a month if one chants more than 333,333 names every day; in this sacrifice of chanting the name, Bhagavān, the bearer of the name, is worshipped. By worldly standards Haridāsa had no right to a sacrifice, either by birth or by initiation into the Sāvitrī, but, initiated into the sacrifice of the name, he performed it as a brāhmaṇa by initiation (*daikṣa-brāhmaṇa*). ↩
21. *Durgā-maṇḍapa-upare* — "in the *durgā-maṇḍapa*". *Anubhāṣya*: in the house of a wealthy non-Vaiṣṇava householder the place where Durgā is worshipped is called the *caṇḍī-maṇḍapa* or *durgā-maṇḍapa*; apart from the four days of the autumn or spring pūjā, guests and outsiders use it. ↩
22. The servant offers Nityānanda a cowshed (*goyālāra gośālā*); the edition's heading to 151: disrespect shown to Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. ↩
23. The edition's heading: Śrī Nityānanda's prophecy (fulfilled in 158–161). ↩
24. *Tāre daṇḍa dite se grāme nā rahilā* — "to punish him, He did not stay in that village": Nityānanda's departure was itself the punishment, followed by the retribution of 158–162 (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "by the curse of Nityānanda Prabhu"). ↩
25. The edition's heading: what becomes of a land where Viṣṇu and the Vaiṣṇavas are hated. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: *majumadāra* (*majmu-ādār*) — under the nawabs, the keeper of the state revenue accounts; *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the district (*muluk*) is Saptagrāma. ↩
27. The edition's headings: to 176 — all take *nāmābhāsa* for the pure name; to 177 — the Ṭhākura proclaims the fruit of the pure name. ↩

28. The same verse as Ādi 7.94; translation as there. The reference is confirmed by the edition's heading. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: as a secondary fruit the name frees one from the bondage of saṁsāra and destroys sin, attachment to saṁsāra; the chief fruit of sunrise is that the sun shines, lights up everything and gives joy, while the vanishing of darkness is a by-product. The edition's heading: *nāmābhāsa* and its fruit, the removal of *anarthas*, are already contained in the pure name and its fruit, the awakening of prema. ↩
30. The source follows the edition's heading: a verse of the *Nāma-kaumudī* of Śrī Lakṣmīdhara Svāmī quoted in the *Padyāvalī* (the number 16 is not given there). *Anubhāṣya*: the name is a blessing for the world up to prema; "rising" — appearing in the senses of one turned towards service, through chanting, hearing and the like; sin is the cause of saṁsāra. ↩
31. *Nāmodayārambhe* — "at the beginning of the name's rising", *udaya kaile* — "when it has risen": the dawn is *nāmābhāsa*, which frees one from sin and gives liberation (185); the full sunrise is the pure name, which gives prema. The edition's headings: to 182 — the Ṭhākura explains the truth of the pure name and of *nāmābhāsa*; to 184 — the fruit of the name is the awakening of love for Kṛṣṇa. ↩
32. The edition's heading: liberation is given by *nāmābhāsa* itself. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: even if Kṛṣṇa wishes to give liberation to a pure devotee, the devotee does not accept it. Haridāsa's speech ends here in the edition. ↩
33. The same verse as 63; translation as there. ↩
34. The same verse as Ādi 4.207; translation as there. The edition here reads *sārūpya-sāmīpya* (*sārūpya* before *sāmīpya*; in Ādi 4.207 and Madhya 9.268 the usual order); the text follows the edition, the meaning is unchanged. ↩
35. *Ārindā* — a tax collector, a messenger who carries the royal revenue (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on 188). ↩
36. The same verse as Ādi 7.98; translation as there. Haridāsa's speech (193–195) ends here in the edition. ↩
37. *Tomāra nāka kāṭi' karaha niścaya*: *karaha* is an imperative addressed to Haridāsa — "give your firm word to cut off your nose"; Haridāsa answers in kind (197), and the edition's heading to 197 is "the Ṭhākura accepts the oath". It is Gopāla's own nose that falls off (207). ↩
38. *Ghaṭa-paṭiyā* — a logician (*naiyāyika*) who argues idly about "pot" (*ghaṭa*) and "cloth" (*paṭa*) (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*); the edition's

heading calls him an atheistic sophist (*hetuvādī*) and adds that Balarāma cursed him (200). ↩

39. The edition's heading: he asks Kṛṣṇa for the welfare of all. ↩
40. The edition reads *yāte tomāra rakṣā haya* — "so that You are protected" (another reading: *mora*, "I"): Haridāsa asks Advaita to guard His own standing; *rakṣā* — protection of one's place in society from public shame and censure (*Anubhāṣya*). ↩
41. *Śrāddha-pātra*: on the day of *śrāddha* a Vaiṣṇava householder first offers all kinds of food to the Lord and then feeds Vaiṣṇavas and brāhmaṇas; Advaita fed Haridāsa as the *śrāddha-pātra*, seeing in him a transcendental brāhmaṇa and guru (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). The *Anubhāṣya* quotes the *Garuḍa Purāṇa* from the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (117): among ten million knowers of Vedānta the best is a devotee of Viṣṇu; even a *mleccha* who has the eightfold bhakti is the best of brāhmaṇas, to be honoured like Hari. ↩
42. *Dīkṣāra viśrāma* — "rest from the vow": Haridāsa is consecrated (*dīkṣita*) to his sacrifice of the name every day (238). ↩
43. *Anubhāṣya*: while he chanted, Haridāsa's mind was always absorbed in Kṛṣṇa's name, and so Māyā-devī's charms, which allure men and bewitch conditioned souls, proved as fruitless as weeping in an empty forest. ↩
44. The edition's heading to 252: without cultivating devotion to Kṛṣṇa under the shelter of Caitanya, a soul is like dead matter. *Anubhāṣya*: a *mahā-yuga* is 4,320,000 solar years, a thousand *mahā-yugas* make a *kalpa*, and *koṭi-kalpa* is ten million times as long. ↩
45. The edition's heading: Māyā-devī falls prostrate before the Ṭhākura, and he initiates her into the *mahā-mantra*, the name of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
46. The edition reads *prema-nāma āsvādana*, "relishes love and the name" (another reading: *prema-rasa*, "the taste of love"); cf. 262. The edition's heading: Kṛṣṇa Himself relishes love for His own sweetness. ↩
47. The edition's heading: even Māyā-devī longs to taste love for Kṛṣṇa; love for Kṛṣṇa is attained only by the mercy of the pure name and of one who chants the pure name. ↩
48. The edition's heading: by the power of *kṛṣṇa-kīrtana* all forms of the Godhead (*īśa-tattva*), beginning with Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, and all souls, moving and unmoving, become mad with love of Kṛṣṇa. ↩
49. The same colophon verse as Antya 2.172; translation as there. ↩